

Social Science Part 1 — Cbse Annual Exam — 80 Marks

ANSWER KEY — FOR GRADING

Subject: Social Science Part 1 | Class: Class 9

Total Marks: 80 | Time Allowed: 3h | CBSE

General Instructions:

1. Read all questions carefully before answering.
2. All questions are compulsory unless stated otherwise.
3. Marks for each question are indicated on the right.
4. Write neatly and legibly.

Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section A Attempt all 20 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		
1	According to Bhishma in the Mahābhārata, how is dharma defined? (A) The path of non-violence (B) That which upholds beings (C) The principle of sameness (D) The cosmic order of nature Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. In the Mahābhārata, Bhishma says that dharma 'is that which upholds beings; whatever upholds all beings is dharma.' [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	1
2	Which type of dune is crescent-shaped and forms in areas with limited sand and a single wind direction? (A) Longitudinal dunes (B) Star dunes (C) Barchan dunes (D) Parabolic dunes Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. Barchan dunes are crescent-shaped and form in areas with limited sand and a single wind direction, while longitudinal dunes are long ridges parallel to the prevailing wind and star dunes have multiple arms. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
3	What is a consequence of strict permits and licenses in a planned economy that restricts competition among private enterprises? (A) It results in little motivation among enterprises to improve quality or innovate (B) It leads to rapid innovation and better quality products (C) It encourages a large number of enterprises to operate in the market (D) It allows market demand to determine all production decisions Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. In a planned economy, enterprises are heavily regulated by the government through strict permits and licenses. This prevents a large number of enterprises from operating in the market and restricts competition among private enterprises. As a result, there is little motivation among enterprises to improve quality or innovate. [Ch 8: Building Blocks in Economics: The Problem of Choice]	1
4	The Chinese script is described as logographic. What does this mean? (A) Characters represent individual sounds of speech (B) Characters represent only numbers and quantities (C) Characters represent entire words or morphemes rather than sounds (D) Characters are drawn only from left to right in linear fashion Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. Characters represent entire words or morphemes rather than sounds, because the Chinese script is logographic, with characters representing entire words or morphemes (smallest meaningful units of language). [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	1
5	The word 'Economics' comes from the Greek word 'oikonomia'. What is the meaning of its two root words 'oikos' and 'nemein'? (A) Oikos means 'household' and nemein means 'management' (B) Oikos means 'management' and nemein means 'household' (C) Oikos means 'resources' and nemein means 'distribution' (D) Oikos means 'wealth' and nemein means 'production' Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. Oikos means 'household' and nemein means 'management' because the source states that oikonomia is composed of oikos translated as 'household' and nemein best translated as 'management', making economics refer to household management. [Ch 8: Building Blocks in Economics: The Problem of Choice]	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
6	Which of the following gases are identified as greenhouse gases that trap heat and raise global temperatures? (A) Carbon dioxide, methane, nitrous oxide, and water vapour (B) Nitrogen, oxygen, and argon (C) Ozone and helium (D) Hydrogen and nitrogen Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. Carbon dioxide, methane, nitrous oxide, and water vapour — These greenhouse gases trap heat in the atmosphere, raising global temperatures and contributing to climate change. <i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	1
7	What methods do social scientists use to gather information and develop evidence-based explanations? (A) Only laboratory experiments and mathematical modelling (B) Observing people's lives, conducting interviews and surveys, examining documents, and comparing different times and places (C) Only reading ancient texts and scriptures (D) Only statistical analysis of government data Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. Social scientists observe people's lives, conduct interviews and surveys, examine documents, and compare different times and places to gather information from multiple sources and develop evidence-based explanations. <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	1
8	What is a characteristic feature of public goods? (A) They are available only to those who can afford to pay for them (B) They are produced only by private companies for profit (C) They can only be used by one person at a time (D) They are available to all individuals without anyone being excluded Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. Public goods are goods and services that are available to all individuals without anyone being excluded. The use of public goods by some people does not prevent others from using them—for example, parks, roads, police services, street lights, and basic education. <i>[Ch 8: Building Blocks in Economics: The Problem of Choice]</i>	1
9	Which discipline examines the human past and helps us understand how societies change over time? (A) Geography (B) Economics (C) History (D) Political Science	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. History examines the human past and helps us understand how societies change over time. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	
10	Which of the following is NOT one of the four puruṣhārthas, or goals of life, in early Indian thought? (A) Yajña (sacrificial ritual) (B) Dharma (righteousness) (C) Artha (material well-being) (D) Kāma (fulfilment of desires) Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. The four puruṣhārthas are dharma, artha, kāma, and mokṣha. Yajña refers to sacrificial rituals, not one of the four goals of life. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	1
11	Which of the following correctly describes a criterion for State Party recognition involving the 8% vote share? (A) Securing not less than 8% of valid votes in any four or more states (B) Securing not less than 8% of seats in the Lok Sabha from the State concerned (C) Securing not less than 8% of valid votes across all states combined (D) Securing not less than 8% of valid votes polled in the State at a General Election to the Lok Sabha or to the Legislative Assembly of the State Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. One criterion for State Party recognition is securing not less than 8% of the valid votes polled in the State at a General Election to the Lok Sabha from the State or to the Legislative Assembly of the State. [Ch 7: Elections]	1
12	What does the term 'carbon footprint' refer to? (A) The physical mark left by carbon particles on the ground (B) The total amount of greenhouse gases released into the atmosphere as a result of human activities such as energy use, transportation, or production of goods and services (C) The amount of carbon dioxide naturally absorbed by plants (D) The total weight of carbon in a person's body Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. The total amount of greenhouse gases released into the atmosphere as a result of human activities, such as energy use, transportation, or the production of goods and services — This is the definition of carbon footprint.	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	<i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	
13	At the State level, who supervises election work and is appointed by the ECI from among civil servants in consultation with the concerned State Government? (A) The Governor (B) The District Magistrate (C) The Returning Officer (D) The Chief Electoral Officer of the State Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. At the State level, election work is supervised by the Chief Electoral Officer of the State, who is appointed by the ECI from among the civil servants in consultation with the concerned State Government. <i>[Ch 7: Elections]</i>	1
14	The area around the Pacific Ocean where most earthquakes and volcanoes occur is known as: (A) Ring of Earthquakes (B) Ring of Fire (C) Pacific Belt of Volcanoes (D) Circum-Pacific Zone Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. Most earthquakes and volcanoes occur along plate boundaries, especially around the Pacific Ocean, an area known as the Ring of Fire. <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	1
15	What was the most significant contribution of Hammurabi to the Babylonian civilisation? (A) The invention of the wheeled cart (B) The construction of the first ziggurat (C) The development of cuneiform writing (D) The compilation of the Code of Hammurabi for civil and social conduct Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. Hammurabi's most significant contribution was the compilation of rules and regulations for civil and social conduct known as the Code of Hammurabi, which served as a foundational model for many future legal systems. <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
16	At a transform boundary, what is the primary geological effect? (A) Formation of fold mountains (B) Creation of new crust through magma rising (C) Earthquakes, as plates slide past each other without creating or destroying crust (D) Volcanic eruptions due to one plate sinking beneath another Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. At a transform boundary, plates slide past each other without creating or destroying crust. This type of movement mainly causes earthquakes, such as along the San Andreas Fault in the United States. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	1
17	How many rites of passage, known as śhoḍaśha saṃskāras, accompanied the stages of life in early Indian society? (A) Sixteen (B) Four (C) Eight (D) Twelve Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. The śhoḍaśha saṃskāras, or the 'sixteen rites of passage', marked significant moments throughout an individual's life. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	1
18	Who found the Rosetta Stone while repairing a fort in Egypt in 1799? (A) Jean-François Champollion (B) Pierre Bouchard (C) Herodotus (D) Napoleon Bonaparte Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. Pierre Bouchard, because he was a French army engineer who found the Rosetta Stone while repairing a fort in Egypt in 1799. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	1
19	Geography helps answer questions like why India has historically been a hub of global interaction. What geographical feature is cited as facilitating contact with Africa, Europe, and Southeast Asia? (A) The Himalayan mountain range (B) The Thar Desert (C) The Indo-Gangetic plain (D) The Indian peninsula's long coastline Answer: Correct Option: (D)	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? D. The Indian peninsula's long coastline facilitated contact with Africa, Europe, and Southeast Asia, making India historically a hub of global interaction. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	
20	When was the Election Commission of India established? (A) 26 January 1950 (B) 25 January 1950 (C) 15 August 1947 (D) 26 November 1949 Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. The Election Commission of India is an autonomous permanent constitutional body that was established on 25 January 1950. This date is also celebrated as National Voters' Day every year. [Ch 7: Elections]	1
Section B Attempt 5 out of 7.		
21	What inclusive voting initiative was extended across India for the first time during the 2024 General Elections? Answer: Voting from home for senior citizens above 85 years of age and persons with disabilities (PwDs) with a benchmark disability of 40% was extended across India for the first time during the 2024 General Elections. ► Why? This question tests recall of a specific inclusive initiative introduced during a particular election. [Ch 7: Elections]	2
	OR What system of weights and measurement did the Harappans follow, and how was it structured? Answer: The Harappans followed a binary multiple system (1, 2, 4, 8, 16, etc.) for weighing smaller units and used multiples of ten for larger denominations. Cubical stone weights following this system have been reported from several sites. ► Why? The question tests understanding of the standardised weight system that facilitated efficient interregional trade among the Harappans. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	
22	Name the major elements of the atmosphere that impact human life on Earth and state one characteristic of the exosphere.	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: The major elements of the atmosphere that impact human life are temperature, precipitation, humidity, wind, and atmospheric pressure. The exosphere is the uppermost layer of the atmosphere, characterised by very thin air where light gases like helium and hydrogen float into space due to weak gravity. ► Why? The source lists five major elements of weather and climate and describes the exosphere's thin air and escape of light gases due to weak gravity. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	
	OR What is the meaning of vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam, and what core idea of Social Science does it express? Answer: Vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam means 'the world is one family.' It expresses the interconnectedness of human societies across regions and cultures, which lies at the core of what Social Science seeks to understand when studying global interactions and relationships. ► Why? The answer requires recalling both the translation and its significance to Social Science's study of global interdependence. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	
23	Explain how a waterfall is formed and state one economic use of waterfalls. Answer: Waterfalls form in the upper course of rivers where hard rocks resist erosion while softer rocks below are worn away, creating a sudden vertical drop. One economic use of waterfalls is hydroelectric power generation, as the force of falling water can be harnessed to produce electricity. ► Why? The answer combines the geological process of waterfall formation with its practical economic application, both stated in the source. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	2
24	How do market economies and planned economies differ in answering the central economic questions? Answer: Market economies rely on private decisions and demand and supply to answer economic questions, whereas planned economies depend on government control. Mixed economies combine both approaches. ► Why? This tests the ability to compare and contrast different economic systems as described in the source material. [Ch 8: Building Blocks in Economics: The Problem of Choice]	2
25	What were the four puruṣhārthas, and why were dharma and mokṣha considered particularly significant?	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: The four puruṣhārthas were dharma (righteousness), artha (material well-being), kāma (fulfilment of desires), and mokṣha (liberation). Dharma and mokṣha held particular significance as they provided direction and purpose to human life from an ethical point of view. ► Why? The response lists the four goals of life and explains the specific ethical importance of dharma and mokṣha as stated in the source text. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	
Section C Attempt 5 out of 7.		
26	Describe the different landforms formed by a river in its upper, middle, and lower courses. Answer: Rivers shape the land through erosion, transportation, and deposition, creating different landforms along their course. In the upper course, rivers form V-shaped valleys, waterfalls, and rapids due to steep gradients and strong erosive forces. In the middle course, the river starts to meander, forming oxbow lakes and floodplains as it loses energy and begins depositing sediments. In the lower course, the river slows further and deposits large amounts of sediment, forming deltas, levees, and alluvial fans. These landforms play a vital role in agriculture, settlement, and ecosystems. ► Why? The answer requires students to organize river landforms by course and explain the processes responsible for each, showing understanding of river dynamics across its entire course. ► Step-by-step: - Step 1: State that rivers create landforms through erosion, transportation, and deposition. - Step 2: Describe landforms in the upper, middle, and lower courses separately. - Step 3: Mention the significance of these landforms for agriculture, settlement, and ecosystems. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	3
	OR How does insolation affect the distribution of temperature across the Earth's surface? Answer: Insolation is an important factor affecting temperature distribution on Earth. The amount of insolation decreases from the equator towards the poles. As a result, the temperature also decreases from the equator towards the poles. This means regions near the equator receive more solar energy and are generally hotter, while regions closer to the poles receive less insolation and are colder. Additionally, the temperature of the atmosphere varies not only between day and night but also across seasons, with summers tending to be hotter than winters. This variation in insolation is a fundamental driver of global temperature patterns.	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The answer explains the relationship between insolation and temperature, noting that insolation decreases from equator to poles, causing temperature to decrease in the same direction. ► Step-by-step: - Step 1: Define insolation as a key factor affecting temperature distribution. - Step 2: Explain that insolation decreases from the equator towards the poles, causing temperature to decrease similarly. - Step 3: Mention that temperature also varies between day and night and across seasons. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	
27	How does the evidence from the Vedic period reflect a high and respectful position for women in society? Answer: The Vedic period is described as a time when women held a high and respectful position in society. Women participated in scholarly learning and, in certain contexts, performed rituals alongside their male counterparts. Textual references indicate that women took part in activities such as chariot races and attended social gatherings, including the sabhā. Several hymns of the Rig Veda are attributed to women sages—most notably Apālā, Viṣhvavārā, Ghoshā, and Lopāmudrā—highlighting women's active engagement in intellectual and religious life. Additionally, goddesses such as Uṣha, the goddess of dawn, and Aditi, the mother of the gods, occupied revered positions. The Manu-smṛiti also states that where women are honoured, the gods rejoice, and where they are not, all sacred rites prove fruitless. ► Why? The answer cites women's participation in scholarly learning, rituals, chariot races, the sabhā, Rig Vedic hymns by women sages, and revered goddesses to show their high status. ► Step-by-step: - Step 1: State that women held a high and respectful position and participated in scholarly learning and rituals. - Step 2: Mention specific examples like chariot races, attendance at the sabhā, and women sages of the Rig Veda. - Step 3: Cite the Manu-smṛiti verse and mention revered goddesses to reinforce the argument. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	3
	OR What role will Social Science play in addressing future challenges faced by societies? Answer: As societies change rapidly due to new technologies, expanding cities, environmental concerns, migration, and global connections, the importance of Social Science continues to grow. It will help societies address complex issues such as climate change, sustainable development, social harmony, and equitable use of resources. Social Science will also guide the responsible use of new technologies and support communities as they adapt to changing conditions. Most importantly, it prepares students not only to understand the world but also to take part in shaping it as informed and thoughtful citizens, while strengthening national unity and keeping us rooted in our rich cultural traditions.	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The source outlines specific future challenges and the dual role of Social Science in both understanding and actively shaping society. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Identify the drivers of rapid societal change 2. Step 2: List the complex future issues Social Science will help address 3. Step 3: Explain its role in shaping citizens and strengthening unity and traditions [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	
28	Describe how fossils are formed and explain their importance in reconstructing human history. Answer: Fossils are the preserved remains, traces, or impressions of plants, animals, or humans from the distant past. They form when these remains get buried under layers of earth and slowly turn into stone over thousands or millions of years. The remains of some of our early ancestors were buried deep underground and over time turned into fossils. The discovery of such fossils, along with discarded tools, are major sources of evidence that help archaeologists reconstruct human history and understand how our ancestors lived. For example, it is through such findings that we know Homo habilis lived in Africa, especially in the Olduvai Gorge in Tanzania and Kenya. ► Why? The answer defines fossils, explains their formation process, and connects them to archaeological reconstruction of human history with a specific example. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Define fossils and describe the process of their formation. 2. Step 2: Explain how early human remains turned into fossils underground. 3. Step 3: State the importance of fossil discoveries for archaeologists, with the Homo habilis example. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	3
29	Describe the key features of a planned economy. What are its main limitations? Answer: In a planned economy, a central planning authority of the government, such as the planning commission, makes all major economic decisions—what and how much will be produced, how they will be produced, and who will get to use them and at what prices. The government has ownership in most resources and sectors like land, factories, banks, and transport. Enterprises follow the central authority's targets rather than market demand, and are heavily regulated through strict permits and licenses. The main limitation is that this restricts competition among private enterprises, as only a limited number can operate in the market. As a result, there is little motivation among enterprises to improve quality or innovate. Examples of planned economies include the former Soviet Union, North Korea, and Cuba.	3



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The answer covers the defining features of a planned economy—central authority, government ownership, strict regulation—and its key limitation of reduced competition and lack of innovation motivation, all drawn from the source. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Define a planned economy with its central planning authority and government ownership 2. Step 2: Describe how enterprises follow targets rather than market demand and are regulated by permits and licenses 3. Step 3: Explain the limitation—restricted competition leads to little motivation to improve quality or innovate, and cite examples [Ch 8: Building Blocks in Economics: The Problem of Choice]	
30	What factors does the Election Commission of India consider while deciding the election schedule, and why are these factors important? Answer: When the constitutionally mandated term of the Legislature ends, which is five years, or when the Legislature is dissolved before completing its term, the ECI activates the machinery to conduct an election. While deciding the election schedule for a country as large and diverse as India, the ECI must consider several factors such as weather conditions, the agricultural cycle, school and university examination schedules, and festivals. These factors are important because India's vast diversity means that elections must be timed to avoid disrupting citizens' daily lives and livelihoods. Weather conditions can affect voter turnout and logistics, the agricultural cycle impacts farmers' availability, and examination schedules and festivals ensure that students and families are not inconvenienced, making the electoral process inclusive and accessible. ► Why? The answer identifies the specific factors the ECI considers and explains why each matters for conducting elections in a diverse country like India. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: State when the ECI activates election machinery 2. Step 2: List the factors considered: weather, agricultural cycle, examinations, and festivals 3. Step 3: Explain why these factors matter for inclusivity and accessibility in a diverse country [Ch 7: Elections]	3
Section D Attempt 4 out of 6.		
31	Discuss how the River Nile shaped the growth of Egyptian civilisation, and explain how the Egyptians' understanding of their environment influenced their calendar, governance, and religious practices including mummification and pyramid construction.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: The River Nile played a central role in the growth of Egyptian civilisation. Egypt saw the emergence of city-states around 3000 BCE as population increased and resources became available. The Nile watered the land along its banks, and every summer the river flooded, leading to annual inundations that deposited rich mud called 'kemet', which was excellent for growing crops. Egyptians referred to their land as Kemet, meaning 'the black', coming from the black river valley soil. About 5000 years ago, farmers discovered that by digging ditches they could divert water from the Nile into their fields and store water in reservoirs for later use. By counting the days between Nile floods, the Egyptians developed a calendar with three seasons — Inundation (autumn), Peret growing (winter), and Shemu harvest (summer) — based on the rising of Sirius (Dog Star), with a year of 365 days (12 months × 30 days + 5 extra days). The need to dig ditches and construct dams required collective effort, which led to the growth of local government and the rise of an administrative class, probably the earliest form of local government in Egypt. Over time, powerful individuals called Pharaohs emerged as rulers. Egyptians believed that each person had a ka (a spiritual double) that lived on after death if the body was preserved through mummification. Mummification involved removing the internal organs (except the heart), drying the body with natron, oiling it, wrapping it in linen strips, placing it in a coffin, and burying it with rituals. After death, pharaohs were buried deep underground with a rectangular structure called a mastaba placed over the burial chamber. Gradually, these mastabas were placed one on top of the other to form a pyramid, such as the step pyramid at Saqqara. Thus, the Nile's floods, the need for cooperation, and religious beliefs together shaped Egyptian civilisation. ► Why? <i>The Nile's annual flooding created fertile land and necessitated cooperative irrigation efforts, which in turn gave rise to governance, calendar systems, and religious practices centered on the afterlife.</i> ► Step-by-step: <i>Step 1: Introduce how the Nile supported Egyptian civilisation — city-states around 3000 BCE, annual flooding, and 'kemet' soil.</i> <i>Step 2: Explain the development of the calendar based on Nile flood cycles and the rising of Sirius, with three seasons and 365 days.</i> <i>Step 3: Describe how collective irrigation efforts led to local government and the rise of the administrative class and Pharaohs.</i> <i>Step 4: Explain religious beliefs — the ka, mummification process, and pyramid construction from mastabas, citing the step pyramid at Saqqara.</i> <i>Step 5: Conclude by connecting the Nile's influence across agriculture, governance, calendar, and religion.</i> <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	
	OR Political parties play a fundamental role in ensuring that democracy functions effectively. Discuss the various ways in which political parties contribute to the electoral process and democratic governance in India.	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Political parties are central to the functioning of democracy in India. They help ensure that democracy functions effectively by providing governance, accountability, representation, and public engagement. Voters learn about candidates, their policies, their vision for development, and their positions on various social, economic, cultural, and political issues primarily through political parties. Since there are often hundreds of contestants for each constituency, parties help voters navigate the choices by presenting clear agendas. During election campaigns, political parties present their agenda, elaborate on their promises in election rallies, and discuss and debate issues of local, state, national, and international concern through various media platforms. This helps set the election agenda and informs citizens about various issues that affect their daily lives. Political parties present diverse viewpoints in terms of programmes and policies, thus helping voters make informed choices. India has a multi-party system, which means many political parties exist and compete in elections. This system reflects the country's rich diversity of languages, cultures, religions, and regions. By representing this diversity, parties ensure that different sections of society find a voice in the democratic process. Most candidates belong to a political party, and parties provide the organisational structure through which candidates contest elections. In this way, political parties act as a bridge between voters and the government, making the democratic process meaningful and participatory. ► Why? Political parties serve as the primary link between voters and the democratic system by providing representation, accountability, and public engagement, while also setting the election agenda through campaigns and debates. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce the role of political parties in ensuring democracy functions effectively through governance, accountability, representation, and public engagement. 2. Step 2: Explain how voters learn about candidates, policies, and development visions primarily through political parties. 3. Step 3: Describe how parties present agendas, make promises in election rallies, and debate issues through media platforms. 4. Step 4: Discuss India's multi-party system and how it reflects the country's diversity of languages, cultures, religions, and regions. 5. Step 5: Conclude with how parties present diverse viewpoints in programmes and policies, helping voters make informed choices. [Ch 7: Elections]	
32	Weathering and erosion are continuous processes that reshape the Earth's surface. Explain the different types of weathering and erosion, and analyze how erosion impacts various human occupations and livelihoods.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Weathering is the process through which rocks on the Earth's surface break down into smaller pieces without involving movement of the broken material. There are three main types of weathering. Physical weathering occurs when rocks break into smaller pieces due to temperature changes, frost, or wind. Chemical weathering happens when minerals in rocks change because of reactions with water, air, or acids, leading to new substances. Biological weathering is caused by plants, animals, or micro-organisms, for example, when plant roots grow into cracks of rocks and split them apart. Weathering plays an important role in shaping the Earth's surface and forming soil. Erosion is the process by which soil, rocks, and other surface materials are worn away and carried from one place to another by natural agents like water, wind, ice, or waves. Unlike weathering, erosion involves movement of the broken material. Types of erosion include water erosion caused by rivers, rain, or ocean waves; wind erosion common in dry and sandy areas; glacial erosion where moving ice scrapes and carries rocks; and coastal erosion where sea waves wear away land along the shore. Erosion significantly affects human occupations. For farmers, erosion removes the fertile topsoil needed for crop growth, leading to lower yields. For those living near rivers and coasts, erosion can wash away land, houses, and roads, causing damage and loss of property. In construction and mining, erosion destabilises land, posing safety risks. Even industries like tourism and fishing suffer, since beaches, rivers, and fertile lands may be destroyed. Historical Indian practices like the Zabo system in Nagaland used earthen bunds and check dams to reduce water velocity, prevent soil erosion, and allow sediment deposition, showing how communities actively responded to erosion challenges. ► Why? The question integrates the concepts of weathering types, erosion types, and their direct consequences on human livelihoods, requiring students to connect natural processes with socio-economic impacts. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Define weathering and explain its three types — physical, chemical, and biological — with examples from the source. 2. Step 2: Define erosion and distinguish it from weathering by highlighting the movement of material. 3. Step 3: Describe the four types of erosion — water, wind, glacial, and coastal — with their causes. 4. Step 4: Analyze how erosion impacts farmers, coastal dwellers, construction workers, and tourism/fishing industries. 5. Step 5: Conclude by mentioning historical responses to erosion, such as the Zabo system in Nagaland. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	
	OR Describe the social organization of early India from the family unit to the jana, and explain how the concepts of gotra, varṇa, āśhrama, and puruṣhārtha together structured an individual's life and duties. How did these frameworks contribute to social harmony?	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: In early India, social organization was structured hierarchically from the family to the larger community. A group of grāmas together formed a viśha, headed by a viśhapati. Above the viśha was the jana, with the rājā serving as the chief protector of the jana, or the people. In this way, the family or kula was inseparable from the jana. During the later Vedic period, the term kula came to denote a household comprising several members bound by kinship. The concept of gotra referred to a patrilineal lineage or clan traced to a common ancestor, traditionally linked to a Vedic sage (ṛṣi). Gotra affiliation often played an important role in regulating marriage practices. Patrilineal descent meant that family identity and inheritance were passed down strictly through the male line. Everyone was expected to perform the duties appropriate to their varṇa and stage of life (āśhrama). The division of one's life into the four āśhramas and their respective dharmas, in principle, provided fulfilment to the person in their social, moral, and spiritual aspects, which would lead to harmony and balance in society. All stages of life were accompanied by numerous rituals and ceremonies, particularly the śhoḍaśha saṃskāras, or the 'sixteen rites of passage', marking significant moments including birth, initiation into education, completion of studies, engagement, marriage, the birth of children, the marriage of children, death rites for parents and their memorial ceremonies, and finally one's own death. Apart from the āśhramas, the concept of the four goals of life or puruṣhārthas was also significant: (1) righteousness (dharma); (2) material well-being (artha); (3) fulfilment of desires (kāma); and (4) liberation from all worldly ties (mokṣha). The fulfilment of these four ends of life is important for every human being. In this framework, dharma and mokṣha hold particular significance from an ethical point of view, as they provide direction and purpose to human life. For instance, the pursuit of wealth (artha) is a desirable objective, provided it is guided by dharma, that is, aligned with the welfare of society. Together, these frameworks—gotra regulating marriage, varṇa defining social duties, āśhrama organizing life stages, and puruṣhārtha guiding life goals—created an integrated system where individual fulfilment was linked to social harmony and balance. ► Why? The answer integrates the hierarchical social structure (grāma, viśha, jana) with the life-organizing frameworks of gotra, varṇa, āśhrama, and puruṣhārtha, showing how they collectively contributed to social harmony. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Describe the hierarchical social organization from grāma to viśha (headed by viśhapati) to jana (protected by rājā), and explain how kula was inseparable from jana. 2. Step 2: Define gotra as a patrilineal lineage traced to a common ancestor linked to a Vedic sage, and explain its role in regulating marriage practices, noting the patrilineal system of inheritance through the male line. 3. Step 3: Explain the concept of varṇa and āśhrama—everyone performing duties appropriate to their varṇa and stage of life, with the four āśhramas providing fulfilment in social, moral, and spiritual aspects leading to harmony. 4. Step 4: Discuss the śhoḍaśha saṃskāras (sixteen rites of passage) marking significant life moments from birth to death, showing how rituals structured an individual's journey. 5. Step 5: Explain the four puruṣhārthas (dharma, artha, kāma, mokṣha), emphasizing the ethical significance of dharma and mokṣha, and how dharma guides artha toward societal welfare. Conclude by showing how all these frameworks together contributed to social harmony and balance. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
33	Explain the key question of 'how to produce' in economics. Discuss the factors that influence an enterprise's choice between labour-intensive and capital-intensive methods of production, using suitable examples. Answer: After deciding what to produce, the next key question in economics is how to produce it—which methods, resources, and technologies should be used. To answer this, producers must select the right mix of factors of production—land, labour, capital, and technology. Production can be labour-intensive (using more workers and less machinery) or capital-intensive (using more machines and technology and fewer workers). Usually, economic activities related to agriculture and handicrafts rely more on labour, whereas industries such as steel and automobile manufacturing depend more on machinery. The choice of production technique depends on several factors. First, the cost of capital matters: if machines are expensive, a firm will rely more on labour, but if machines become affordable, it may shift to automation. Second, the level of technology available is crucial—advanced technology encourages machine use, while limited technology leads to manual production. Third, the nature of the product is important: customised or designer clothes require skilled labour, whereas mass-produced garments are better suited for machines. Fourth, the availability and relative cost of factors of production influence the decision—if labour is cheap and easily available, labour-intensive methods are preferred, but if labour is costly or scarce, machines become more efficient. Finally, government laws and regulations, such as labour laws or incentives for machinery, also influence this decision. For example, a garment manufacturer must choose between labour-intensive and capital-intensive methods based on all these considerations, ensuring that limited resources are used efficiently and not wasted. ► Why? The 'how to produce' question addresses the selection of production techniques based on cost of capital, technology availability, nature of product, labour availability, and government regulations. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce the 'how to produce' question as one of the three key questions in economics. 2. Step 2: Explain labour-intensive and capital-intensive production methods with examples from agriculture, handicrafts, steel, and automobile manufacturing. 3. Step 3: Discuss the factors influencing the choice—cost of capital, technology level, nature of product, availability and cost of labour, and government laws and regulations. 4. Step 4: Use the garment manufacturer example to illustrate how these factors interact in decision-making. 5. Step 5: Conclude by emphasising that the choice ensures efficient use of limited resources. [Ch 8: Building Blocks in Economics: The Problem of Choice]	5
34	Why should we study Social Science? Discuss how it helps us understand the systems around us, appreciate diversity, participate in democratic life, and connect the past, present, and future.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Social Science is essential because it helps us understand the systems created and managed by society—such as the houses we live in, the water we use, the roads we travel on, the schools we attend, the markets we visit, and even the digital spaces we use. It explains how these systems developed, how they function, and how they affect different groups of people. We live among people who speak different languages, follow diverse customs, and practise varied occupations. Social Science explains these variations as outcomes of geographical, historical, cultural, and economic factors. This understanding builds respect and cooperation among communities. It also helps us recognise how Indian culture binds this diversity together through an underlying unity, fostering a sense of belonging and shared identity. In a democratic society, citizens play an active role in public life. Laws, rights, and responsibilities guide how people live together. Understanding how governments function and how decisions are made prepares us to participate responsibly in civic life. Social Science strengthens our ability to think about shared challenges such as environmental protection, public health, employment, or urban growth. We learn to ask informed questions about their causes, effects, and possible solutions. This habit of careful questioning and reasoning is essential for addressing problems that affect society as a whole. Most importantly, Social Science connects the past, present, and future. By understanding how past decisions shaped the present, we become better equipped to make wiser choices for the future. It helps us see society as one connected story rather than a collection of separate pieces, preparing us to take part in shaping the world as informed and thoughtful citizens. ► Why? The answer integrates the multiple purposes of studying Social Science as outlined in the source: understanding societal systems, appreciating diversity, enabling democratic participation, and linking past, present, and future. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce the importance of Social Science in understanding everyday systems like housing, water, roads, schools, markets, and digital spaces. 2. Step 2: Explain how Social Science accounts for diversity in languages, customs, and occupations through geographical, historical, cultural, and economic factors, and how it fosters unity and shared identity. 3. Step 3: Discuss the role of Social Science in democratic participation—understanding government functioning, laws, rights, responsibilities, and asking informed questions about shared challenges. 4. Step 4: Highlight how Social Science connects past, present, and future, enabling wiser choices for the future. 5. Step 5: Conclude by emphasising that Social Science helps us see society as one connected story and prepares us to be informed, thoughtful citizens. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	
Section E Attempt 3 out of 4.		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
35	Case Study: Understanding Society Through a Village's Daily Life A village in India is situated near a long coastline that historically facilitated contact with Africa, Europe, and Southeast Asia. The villagers depend on farming, while some engage in trade. The local Panchayati Raj system gives citizens a voice in local development planning, reflecting grassroots democracy. Roads are maintained by public authorities, and electricity arrives from distant power stations through a vast network. The food villagers eat has been harvested, processed, transported, bought, and sold through the efforts of many people. Social Science helps explain why agriculture flourishes here, how governments make decisions affecting millions, and how environments influence life. Society does not function by chance—it is shaped by history, geography, institutions, resources, and human choices. (i) Define Social Science in simple words. (ii) How does the Panchayati Raj system embody grassroots democracy in India's villages? (iii) Explain how the village's daily life demonstrates the interconnection of multiple Social Science disciplines. Refer to at least two disciplines. (iv) Why does the passage state that 'society does not function by chance'? What factors shape it? Answer: (i) Social Science is the systematic study of human society. (ii) The Panchayati Raj system embodies grassroots democracy by giving citizens a voice in local development planning, showing that political power exists not only within formal institutions but also in social relationships, customs, and ideas of legitimacy. (iii) The village's daily life connects multiple disciplines: Geography explains why the coastline facilitated contact with other regions and how the environment influences farming and settlement. Political Science explains how the Panchayati Raj system gives citizens a voice in governance. Economics explains how food is harvested, processed, transported, bought, and sold through the efforts of many people. Each discipline asks different questions, yet all are interconnected and together provide a holistic understanding of society. (iv) Society is shaped by history, geography, institutions, resources, and human choices. Social Science helps explore questions about society through careful observation, evidence, and logical reasoning. ► Why? i) Social Science is the systematic study of human society. ii) The Panchayati Raj system embodies grassroots democracy by giving citizens a voice in local development planning, showing that political power exists not only within formal institutions but also in social relationships, customs, and ideas of legitimacy. iii) The village's daily life connects multiple disciplines: Geography explains why the coastline facilitated contact with other regions and how the environment influences farming and settlement. Political Science explains how the Panchayati Raj system gives citizens a voice in governance. Economics explains how food is harvested, processed, transported, bought, and sold through the efforts of many people. Each discipline asks different questions, yet all are interconnected and together provide a holistic understanding of society. iv) Society is shaped by history, geography, institutions, resources, and human choices. Social Science helps explore questions about society through careful observation, evidence, and logical reasoning.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	
	OR Case Study: Tectonic Plates and Plate Boundaries The Earth's lithosphere is broken into massive slabs of solid rock called tectonic plates, which move very slowly, usually a few centimetres per year. The movement of these plates is caused by convection currents in the mantle, where heat from the Earth's core causes molten material to rise while cooler material sinks. At plate boundaries, different interactions occur. When two continental plates collide, they form fold mountains, such as the Himalaya. When an oceanic plate collides with a continental plate, the oceanic plate sinks beneath the continental plate, leading to volcanic activity and earthquakes. Where plates move away from each other, magma rises and forms new crust, creating mid-ocean ridges. Where plates slide past each other, earthquakes mainly occur. (i) What causes the movement of tectonic plates? (ii) Name the three main types of plate boundaries. (iii) Explain what happens at a convergent boundary when an oceanic plate collides with a continental plate, and give an example of what forms when two continental plates collide. (iv) Why are most earthquakes and volcanoes found around the Pacific Ocean, and what is this area known as? Answer: (i) The movement of tectonic plates is caused by convection currents in the mantle. Heat from the Earth's core causes molten material in the mantle to rise, while cooler material sinks, creating convection currents that push and pull the plates. (ii) The three main types of plate boundaries are convergent boundary (where two plates move towards each other), divergent boundary (where plates move away from each other), and transform boundary (where plates slide past each other without creating or destroying crust). (iii) When an oceanic plate collides with a continental plate at a convergent boundary, the oceanic plate sinks beneath the continental plate, leading to volcanic activity and earthquakes. When two continental plates collide, they form fold mountains, such as the Himalaya. (iv) Most earthquakes and volcanoes occur along plate boundaries, especially around the Pacific Ocean, an area known as the Ring of Fire. ► Why? i) The movement of tectonic plates is caused by convection currents in the mantle. Heat from the Earth's core causes molten material in the mantle to rise, while cooler material sinks, creating convection currents that push and pull the plates. ii) The three main types of plate boundaries are convergent boundary (where two plates move towards each other), divergent boundary (where plates move away from each other), and transform boundary (where plates slide past each other without creating or destroying crust). iii) When an oceanic plate collides with a continental plate at a convergent boundary, the oceanic plate sinks beneath the continental plate, leading to volcanic activity and earthquakes. When two continental plates collide, they form fold mountains, such as the Himalaya. iv) Most earthquakes and volcanoes occur along plate boundaries, especially around the Pacific Ocean, an area known as the Ring of Fire. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
36	Case Study: Egyptian Civilisation — Calendar, Agriculture and Governance About 5000 years ago, farmers discovered that by digging ditches they could divert water from the Nile into their fields and store water in reservoirs for later use. By counting the days between Nile floods, the Egyptians developed a calendar. The Egyptian calendar has three seasons — Inundation (autumn), Peret growing (winter) and shemu harvest (summer). It is based on the rising of Sirius (Dog Star), with a year of 365 days. The need to dig ditches and construct dams required collective effort, which led to the growth of local government and the rise of an administrative class — probably the earliest form of local government in Egypt. (i) What are the three seasons of the Egyptian calendar? (ii) On what astronomical basis was the Egyptian calendar founded? (iii) How did agricultural needs contribute to the rise of local government in Egypt? (iv) Why was the Egyptian calendar of 365 days not perfectly accurate? Answer: (i) Inundation (autumn), Peret growing (winter), and shemu harvest (summer). (ii) It was based on the rising of Sirius, the Dog Star. (iii) The need to dig ditches and construct dams required collective effort. These early cooperative efforts led to the growth of local government and the rise of an administrative class, forming the earliest form of local government in Egypt. (iv) The real year is about $\frac{1}{4}$ day longer than 365 days, so the calendar lost time over the years. ► Why? i) Inundation (autumn), Peret growing (winter), and shemu harvest (summer). ii) It was based on the rising of Sirius, the Dog Star. iii) The need to dig ditches and construct dams required collective effort. These early cooperative efforts led to the growth of local government and the rise of an administrative class, forming the earliest form of local government in Egypt. iv) The real year is about $\frac{1}{4}$ day longer than 365 days, so the calendar lost time over the years. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
37	Case Study: Monsoon Winds and Their Impact on India During ancient times, sailors travelling to India noticed a seasonal reversal of wind directions. The Arabs named this phenomenon 'monsoon', derived from the Arabic word 'mausim', meaning season. The south-west monsoon, occurring between June and September, is caused by the unequal heating of land and sea. The Indian landmass heats up faster than surrounding oceans, creating a low-pressure area over the subcontinent while the Indian Ocean remains cooler with high pressure. Moist winds blow from ocean to land, bringing rainfall. The north-east monsoon, from October to February, reverses this pattern. Monsoon rainfall is vital for agriculture, water supply, and the economy, though excessive rainfall causes floods and weak monsoons cause droughts. (i) From which Arabic word is the term 'monsoon' derived and what does it mean? (ii) How does unequal heating of land and sea create the south-west monsoon? (iii) Explain how the north-east monsoon differs from the south-west monsoon in terms of pressure distribution and rainfall pattern. (iv) Why is the monsoon considered vital for India's economy and livelihoods? Answer: (i) The term 'monsoon' is derived from the Arabic word 'mausim', which literally means season. (ii) During summer, the Indian landmass heats up faster than the surrounding oceans, creating a low-pressure area over the subcontinent. The Indian Ocean remains relatively cooler with high pressure. Winds move from high-pressure to low-pressure areas, so moist winds blow from the ocean towards the land, bringing rainfall. (iii) During the north-east monsoon (October-February), the Indian landmass cools faster than the surrounding oceans, creating a high-pressure area over land and low pressure over the seas. Cold, dry winds blow from land to sea, generally not bringing rainfall to most of India. However, when these winds pass over the Bay of Bengal, they pick up moisture and cause rainfall on the eastern coast, especially Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, and parts of Karnataka. In contrast, the south-west monsoon (June-September) brings moist winds from sea to land and accounts for most of the rainfall in the country. (iv) Most of India's agriculture depends on monsoon rainfall, as farmers rely on rain for sowing and growing crops. A good monsoon ensures sufficient food production and water supply in rivers, reservoirs, and wells. Monsoon also affects daily life, transport, festivals, and employment, especially in rural areas, greatly influencing the economy and livelihoods.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? i) The term 'monsoon' is derived from the Arabic word 'mausim', which literally means season. ii) During summer, the Indian landmass heats up faster than the surrounding oceans, creating a low-pressure area over the subcontinent. The Indian Ocean remains relatively cooler with high pressure. Winds move from high-pressure to low-pressure areas, so moist winds blow from the ocean towards the land, bringing rainfall. iii) During the north-east monsoon (October-February), the Indian landmass cools faster than the surrounding oceans, creating a high-pressure area over land and low pressure over the seas. Cold, dry winds blow from land to sea, generally not bringing rainfall to most of India. However, when these winds pass over the Bay of Bengal, they pick up moisture and cause rainfall on the eastern coast, especially Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, and parts of Karnataka. In contrast, the south-west monsoon (June-September) brings moist winds from sea to land and accounts for most of the rainfall in the country. iv) Most of India's agriculture depends on monsoon rainfall, as farmers rely on rain for sowing and growing crops. A good monsoon ensures sufficient food production and water supply in rivers, reservoirs, and wells. Monsoon also affects daily life, transport, festivals, and employment, especially in rural areas, greatly influencing the economy and livelihoods. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	

